

CDN Incident Alert: 0061. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	PL The EU accused of election interference in Poland by foreign and foreign-aligned sources	13/05/2025

Summary

- Between March 3 and April 9, 3 accusations of the EU engaging in election interference in Poland were spread by foreign and pro-Russian actors.
- These statements were framed by foreign affiliated malign actors as the evidence that the European Union intended to interfere in Poland's elections to prevent a right-wing candidate from winning.
- The claims were widely amplified by Russian sources and Polish-language foreign affiliated sources.
- The narratives are trying to diminish trust in the electoral process, using conspiracy theories, websites with media personas, and localising content using machine translated text.
- Media entities and the Polish government should inform the population about these attempts of manipulation.

Incident

On March 3, Henna Virkkunen, Vice-President of the European Commission, [announced](#) that the EU intended to hold a round table with Polish authorities to review different election scenarios. Her statement stirred debate among Polish politicians, while foreign and foreign-linked actors claimed it confirmed the EU's plan to interfere in Poland's elections. Claims about the EU's interference in Polish elections were amplified by foreign-aligned Polish-language entities, such as [Lega Artis](#), [Wolne Media](#), [Niezależny dziennik polityczny](#) as well as [Pravda](#) in Polish language. The round table was also discussed in one of Radio Belarus episodes in Polish and speakers claimed that Brussels [intended](#) to "falsify Polish elections". Other Belarusian and Russian state-affiliated [Telegram channels](#) wrote about her statement in Russian language, accusing the EU of interfering in Polish elections. Such claims were also posted by Austrian website [Tkp.at](#) in German, post also appeared in [Italian](#) on Telegram.

On April 4, French far-right politician Florian Philippot [claimed](#) that the European Union was preparing to cancel or invalidate the results of Poland's upcoming presidential election. He portrayed this as proof of growing EU authoritarianism and interference in national democratic processes, calling it a major threat to sovereignty. According to Philippot, Sławomir Mentzen's rising popularity in the polls might prompt the EU to take action against him, warning that Brussels could "do a Georgescu on him" if he appeared likely to win. According to Meltwater, Florian Philippot's tweet was picked up and republished at least 24 times by Russian media, including major state-controlled and pro-government outlets like [Russia Today](#), [Vesti.ru](#), [Gazeta.ru](#), [Argumenty i Fakty](#) and [Ria Novosti](#). In Polish language, the narrative found relatively marginal traction, with reposts by [Lega Artis](#) and [Pravda](#), which also published an article on this statement in [French](#) and [English](#) helping extend the reach of Philippot's claim into both local and regional discourse. Beyond mainstream platforms, the message also spread through a network of at least 20 regional Telegram channels across Russia, all sharing the content in Russian.

Then, on April 9, Polish news site *Myśl Polska* [echoed](#) this narrative, citing the Romanian Constitutional Court's annulment of election results despite a lack of evidence for outside interference. The article also referenced the French court's four-year sentence against Marine Le Pen as an example of judicial overreach. It concluded that, given Mentzen's growing support, Poland's supposedly "free courts" might also find a legal pretext to block his candidacy. In April, Wyborcza [reported](#) that a member of the Polish Commission for the Study of Russian and Belarusian Influence identified *Myśl Polska* as a key center of Russian influence in Poland, and a list of individuals linked to it was handed over to the Polish Internal Security Agency for further investigation. In 2022, Polish government [blocked](#) the website domain of *Myśl Polska* on the territory of Poland. According to Meltwater, *Myśl Polska*'s article was republished at least 40 times by Russian media outlets, including [Ria Novosti](#), [Lenta.ru](#), [Moskovski Komsomolec](#), [Vesti.ru](#) and [Gazeta.ru](#). The story also spread beyond Russian media, appearing in [Polish](#) ([here](#), [here](#), [here](#)), [Romanian](#), [French](#), [Czech](#) and [English](#) languages.

Narrative

Meta-Narrative: The European Union is undermining the sovereignty of its member states by interfering in their internal affairs and democratic processes;

Sub-Narratives: the EU is allegedly preparing to interfere in Polish elections; the EU to block Sławomir Mentzen's path to electoral victory.

Impact

Reach: Meltwater estimates that articles on Russian media websites about Philippot's tweet received over 81,000 views, while those about the Myśl Polska piece drew more than 140,000 views.

Outcome: N/A.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [T0135.003: Subvert](#) – the narratives are trying to diminish trust in the electoral process;

[T0022.001: Amplify Existing Conspiracy Theory Narratives](#) – The claims about Romania and the EC round table were relying on conspiracy theory narrative components;

[T0101: Create Localised Content](#) – The content was spread in multiple languages;

[T0097.202: News Outlet Persona](#) – Several Russian, Belarusian and foreign-aligned Polish media amplified the narratives;

[T0085.008: Machine Translated Text](#) – The Pravda website use Machine Translated Text.

Recommendations and Actions Taken (end each recommendation with a ;)

Action taken: Informed Polish government agencies and press to highlight how this conversation was manipulated.

Recommendations: Spread awareness on how this specific narrative was being amplified by foreign-aligned actors.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	Russia, Belarus	Upon Request	Givi Gigitashvili, Atlantic Council's DFRLab Jakub Szymik CEE Digital Democracy Watch	News websites, Telegram, X,	